



OUTLIERS

# What You Store

Layer 3 of 8 · Recording what happened,  
and letting everything else be worked out.

# Facts, not descriptions

A description of a relationship starts going out of date the moment you write it. A record of something that happened stays correct, because the thing happened.

## WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

Your records have a shape and your system can tell one person from another. But the fields you would naturally fill in, things like their job title or how warm the relationship is, are claims about a moving world. Nobody has to touch them for them to become wrong.

## WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

This layer changes what you keep. Instead of writing down what is true about someone today, your system records what *happened*, one line at a time. Everything else, including when you last spoke and where the relationship stands, is worked out from those lines whenever you ask.

### WRITTEN BY HAND

last spoke: recently

relationship: warm

job title: Head of Ops

true on the day you typed it

### RECORDED AS IT HAPPENED



NOBODY TYPES THE RIGHT-HAND BOX. IT IS CALCULATED.

## How it works

The rules below all follow from the first one, which is that nothing already written down is ever changed.

### 1. ONLY ADD. NEVER EDIT

Things that happened go into a list, one line each, and nothing already in that list is ever changed or removed. If you got something wrong, you add a correction; you do not go back and alter history. That means the record of your relationships cannot change under you without a line being added, so what it said last month is still there.

### 2. A SHORT, FIXED LIST OF WHAT COUNTS AS SOMETHING HAPPENING

You wrote to them. They replied. A call was booked. You met. They changed jobs. They went quiet. Your system knows that list and refuses anything not on it, which stops this becoming another mess in six months. The installer asks what counts as contact in your line of work, because a site visit or a quote sent matters in some businesses and not others.

### 3. THE DESCRIPTIVE FIELDS ARE NOW CALCULATED, AND YOU STOP TYPING THEM

When you last spoke is the date of the most recent thing that happened. How many exchanges you have had is a count. Where the relationship stands follows rules you can read: a reply makes someone active, and a conversation that has gone quiet past a length of time you choose parks itself.

Nobody has to decide to give up on a thread. It steps aside on its own, so your list of live conversations reflects what is still moving.

### WHAT HAPPENS IF THERE IS NO HISTORY YET

Then your system says so, rather than guessing. Someone with nothing recorded against them has not gone cold. Nothing has been observed about them yet. A CRM that assigns a status on no evidence produces a status you cannot rely on.

# Build it

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-03-records
cd outliers-crm-03-records
python install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 and 2. It will check, and tell you if something is missing.

## WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

| QUESTION                                            | WHAT IT CHANGES                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What counts as contact in your business?</b>     | A message, a call, a site visit, a quote sent, a session delivered. Your list, because a builder and a coach do not count the same things.                        |
| <b>After how long is a quiet conversation over?</b> | Thirty days suits most people. Whatever you choose, conversations older than that step aside on their own instead of sitting on your list making you feel guilty. |

## WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- A single history file that only ever gets added to.
- A tool that works out, from that history, when you last spoke to anyone and where things stand.
- A rule that quiet conversations park themselves, so nothing sits on your list forever.
- The rules for what counts as live and what has gone quiet, in plain English, in a file you can edit.

## Now use it

This one only pays off once Layer 4 is filling the history for you. Read what it will do, and come back to it.

If you brought in a contacts export at Layer 1, you can try the calculation now on the handful of people you have spoken to since. Otherwise there is genuinely nothing useful to do here yet, and this guide is not going to invent an exercise to fill the space.

What is worth doing is reading the rules the installer wrote for deciding what counts as live and what has gone quiet. Open your CRM folder in Obsidian and look for a folder called **\_layers**, usually at the bottom of the list. The rules are three short paragraphs in plain English, and your system uses them for as long as you run it. If you disagree with any, change them now, while it costs nothing.

### IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: ask your existing system who you have not spoken to in sixty days. If the answer comes from a field somebody typed, it is a guess. If you cannot get an answer at all, this layer is the one you are missing.

### WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

A history is only as good as what reaches it, and right now the only thing that could put anything in it is you, typing. That is the admin that kills CRMs, so putting it back in at this point would undo the whole point of the exercise.

### NEXT: LAYER 4 • CAPTURE

Your system starts filling its own history from the places your conversations already happen. This is where the typing stops and the thing starts giving back.

### WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

|                         |                                                                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Event</b>            | A record that something happened, with a date and where it came from.      |
| <b>Append-only</b>      | A file that only ever has lines added. Nothing already written is changed. |
| <b>Calculated field</b> | Something worked out from your history rather than typed in.               |
| <b>Parked</b>           | A conversation that has gone quiet and stepped aside on its own.           |